

Team Assignment 3 Question 2 - Scenarios

Admissions Alchemists

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1. Li Lei, a 24-year-old Chinese graduate student completing his MS in Biomedical Science, is preparing to apply for PhD programs in the United States. With a BS in Chemistry and extensive research experience, he is eager to continue his academic journey in biomedical innovation. However, he faces significant challenges in crafting a compelling application due to his limited English proficiency and unfamiliarity with the tone, structure, and expectations of U.S. graduate admissions. Writing a strong Statement of Purpose (SOP) and securing well-crafted Letters of Recommendation (LORs) feels overwhelming, as he struggles to articulate his research achievements and career goals in a way that resonates with admissions committees.

To overcome these challenges, Li turns to GradAid, which helps him generate well-structured, grammatically accurate SOPs and LORs tailored to his background and aspirations. By inputting key details about his academic journey and research experience, he receives personalized drafts that he can refine using GradAid's tone adjustment and clarity-enhancing features. The platform also provides research-focused suggestions to ensure his documents align with the expectations of specific PhD programs. With GradAid's support, Li gains confidence in his application, knowing that his materials effectively highlight his strengths and are presented in a professional, natural-sounding manner.

2. Astha is determined to pursue a graduate degree in the US, but the application process feels overwhelming. Remembering a friend's recommendation, she opens her browser and navigates to GradAid.com. Astha clicks the "Get Started" button and begins interacting with GradAid's AI chatbot.

GradAid asks her a series of questions: her background, academic achievements, work experience, career aspirations, and preferred fields of study. Astha appreciates how GradAid's conversational interface makes it easy to share her story, even the less conventional parts. She explains her medical background, her shift to nursing, and her desire to transition into a more lucrative and stable career to support her parents. Based on Astha's input, GradAid's AI analyzes her profile and generates a list of potential graduate programs in computer science and finance at universities across the US. The recommendations are tailored to her academic record, work history, and career goals. Astha is impressed by the breadth and relevance of the suggestions.

Astha selects a few programs that pique her interest. She knows the Statement of Purpose (SOP) is crucial, and it's where she's been struggling the most. Thankfully, GradAid offers an SOP brainstorming tool. GradAid's AI generates a series of prompts and potential themes for her SOP, suggesting ways to connect her seemingly disparate

experiences into a cohesive narrative. Astha finds this incredibly helpful, as she's able to recognize the transferable skills she's gained, like problem-solving, communication, and adaptability.

3. Carlos has started drafting his Statement of Purpose (SOP) for MS programs in AI, but he's struggling to connect his industry experience in backend development to his passion for machine learning. Unsure of how to frame his background, he logs into GradAid and inputs details about his education, work experience, and research interests.

GradAid analyzes his profile and suggests ways to highlight transferable skills from his software engineering background, such as his experience working with large datasets, optimization algorithms, and distributed computing. The AI-generated SOP draft weaves his technical experience into a compelling narrative, emphasizing how his work has naturally led him toward AI research. The platform also offers AI-powered editing tools to refine the language, ensuring his SOP is both professional and persuasive.

4. Carlos has shortlisted five MS programs in AI, each with slightly different focuses—some emphasize research, while others are more industry-oriented. He wants to tailor his SOP for each program but doesn't know how to efficiently modify his content.

Using GradAid's customization feature, he selects the target programs and receives program-specific suggestions for refining his SOP. The tool highlights key faculty members and research labs he should mention, recommends how to emphasize certain skills based on each program's focus, and adjusts the wording to align with the expectations of research vs. industry-focused programs. With GradAid's help, Carlos creates tailored versions of his SOP, increasing his chances of securing admission.